

# **DOD UNIFIED CAPABILITIES REQUIREMENTS (UCR) REQUEST FOR INFORMATION (RFI) 612673989**

The Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA), Emerging Technology (EM) Directorate, and Defense Information Technology Contracting Organization (DITCO) PS61 are requesting industry input to inform updates to the Department of Defense (DoD) Unified Capabilities Requirements 2013 (UCR 2013), Change 2<sup>1</sup>. This effort focuses on functional areas relevant to current and emerging technologies, system integration, and interoperability.

The RFI seeks industry perspectives on whether existing DoD processes, policies, and infrastructure are aligned to industry practices and technical advancements that have evolved since the establishment of the DoD Information Network (DoDIN) Approved Products List (APL)<sup>2</sup>; Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 8100.04, “*DoD Unified Capabilities*,” dated December 9, 2010<sup>3</sup>; and the UCR 2013, Change 2, dated September 2017.

**THIS IS A REQUEST FOR INFORMATION (RFI) ONLY. THIS IS NOT A REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS (RFP). NO SOLICITATION IS AVAILABLE AT THIS TIME.**

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## **1 OVERVIEW/PURPOSE/DESCRIPTION**

The purpose of this RFI is to gather information on current industry practices, technologies, and standards to assist the Government in assessing whether UCR 2013 continues to accurately reflect current and emerging technologies; aligns with Department of Defense (DoD) enterprise architectures; and supports interoperable, scalable, and secure solutions across the DoDIN.

Additionally, the RFI supports the DoD Chief Information Officer’s (CIO) DoDIN Approved Products List (APL) Sunset Memorandum<sup>4</sup> objectives related to modernization and continuous improvement of Department-wide processes, policies, and instructions, while maintaining security, reliability, interoperability, efficiency, and effectiveness across the DoDIN.

Information received will assist DISA in evaluating potential future approaches related to the evolution of DoDIN APL-based testing and certification processes, as well as the consideration of alternative methods for assessing Unified Capabilities (UC) product alignment with cybersecurity, interoperability, and enterprise integration requirements. Any such considerations are preliminary and subject to further analysis, coordination, and approval.

DISA is interested in industry perspectives regarding the integration and application of technologies that may inform future UCR requirements, including but not limited to modern network architectures, cloud-enabled services, edge computing, automation, artificial intelligence

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<sup>1</sup> [https://www.disa.mil/-/media/Files/DISA/Services/UCCO/UCR2013/UCR\\_2013\\_Combined.pdf](https://www.disa.mil/-/media/Files/DISA/Services/UCCO/UCR2013/UCR_2013_Combined.pdf)

<sup>2</sup> <https://aplists.disa.mil/processAPList.action>

<sup>3</sup> <https://www.esd.whs.mil/Portals/54/Documents/DD/issuances/dodi/810004p.pdf>

<sup>4</sup> [https://aplists.disa.mil/docs/DODIN\\_APL\\_SUNSET.pdf](https://aplists.disa.mil/docs/DODIN_APL_SUNSET.pdf)

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and machine learning (AI/ML), cybersecurity, data interoperability, and system integration across Joint, Coalition, and mission partner environments.

Responses to this RFI are voluntary and will be used solely for market research and planning purposes. Information submitted will not be returned and will not be considered proprietary.

This RFI does not constitute a solicitation, does not represent a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation or award a contract, and does not obligate the Government to pay for any information provided.

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## **2 SCOPE OF EFFORT**

The scope of this RFI is limited to gathering industry feedback to support the review and potential update of the UCR 2013 document. DISA seeks information regarding the relevance, clarity, applicability, and future alignment of existing UCR requirements to current and emerging technologies, operational and mission needs, as well as evolving DoD enterprise architectures.

Industry feedback may also be used to assess the effectiveness of current requirements, processes, and supporting frameworks enabling secure, interoperable, scalable, and efficient UC solutions across the DoDIN. Responses may identify areas where clarification, refinement, or potential future updates could be considered.

Within this scope, respondents may address the following areas, as applicable:

- **Requirement Modernization:** Identification of UCR requirements that may be unclear, duplicative, overly prescriptive, or misaligned with current implementation practices.
- **Emerging Technologies:** Considerations related to evolving technologies such as cloud-native architectures, Zero Trust principles, automation, AI/ML-enabled capabilities, edge computing, software-defined networking, and advanced mobility.
- **Interoperability and Integration:** Observations regarding interoperability across DoD Components, Joint and Coalition partners, and mission environments, including alignment with open standards, modular architectures, and real-time integrative approaches that rationalize differing Joint and Coalition standards.
- **Scalability and Resiliency:** Input related to scalability, resiliency, availability, and performance across enterprise and operational environments.
- **Cybersecurity Alignment:** General observations regarding alignment with DoD cybersecurity policies, risk management frameworks, and secure-by-design principles.

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- **Implementation Considerations:** High-level lessons learned, risks, or constraints associated with implementing UCR-aligned capabilities.

This RFI does not request detailed technical solutions, cost or pricing data, proprietary information, or proposals. Responses should be provided at a conceptual and capability-based level and should not reference specific vendor products or services.

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### **3 REQUESTED INFORMATION**

DISA requests that respondents provide concise, high-level, non-proprietary information using the Government-provided Excel response template. Inputs will inform Government analysis and planning related to updates of the UCR. Respondents shall provide information only in the tabs specified below and in accordance with the instructions embedded in each tab.

#### **3.1 TAB 3: FUNCTIONAL AREA RANKING, ANALYSIS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS (REQUIRED)**

Respondents shall use TAB 3 to provide input on the prioritization, relevance, and recommended disposition of functional areas identified in the current UCR. All responses must align to the Government-predefined ranking categories and column headers provided in the Excel template.

**Inputs should reflect, as applicable:**

- Current and anticipated operational relevance
- Integration with existing, modern, and emerging technologies
- Interoperability across systems, platforms, and Joint, Coalition, and mission partner environments
- Scalability and adaptability to future requirements
- Continued effectiveness of the functional area and associated requirements

Respondents shall use TAB 3 as the primary input mechanism for functional area prioritization and analysis. All entries shall align with the predefined fields and instructions within the tab. Brief narrative responses are permitted only where explicitly indicated.

##### **3.1.1 PART A: FUNCTIONAL AREA RANKING**

Respondents shall review the list of UCR functional areas and select rankings exclusively from the Government-predefined ranking categories included in TAB 3. Respondents shall not create, modify, or supplement ranking scales, definitions, or criteria.

**Required TAB 3 Inputs:**

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- **Current Operational Relevance:** Select from Government-defined options.
- **Modernization Priority:** Select from Government-defined options.
- **Technology Alignment:** Select from Government-defined options.

**3.1.2 PART B: FUNCTIONAL AREA ANALYSIS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**

Where permitted by the template, respondents may provide brief justification and recommendations addressing requirements-level considerations such as:

- Operational relevance or mission impact
- Interoperability or integration considerations
- Architectural alignment
- Modernization or future technology considerations

**Conditional / Narrative Columns (Complete only where applicable):**

- **Integration or Interoperability Challenges:** Select: Yes/No.
- **Integration or Interoperability Considerations:** Provide brief, non-proprietary narrative when “Yes” is selected.
- **Commercial Service or Capability:** Select: Yes/No.
- **Service or Capability Name:** Complete only if “Yes” is selected.
- **DoD Service or Capability Utilization:** Select: Yes/No.
- **Services or Capabilities Provided to DoD Organization(s):** Complete only if applicable.

Inputs should reflect operational relevance, interoperability, architectural alignment, and modernization considerations at the requirements level. Vendor-specific solutions, proprietary approaches, pricing, or product references shall not be included.

**3.2 TAB 4: GAPS, RISKS, AND OBSERVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Respondents may use TAB 4 to provide optional, cross-cutting observations that are not limited to a single functional area. Inputs should address overarching considerations relevant to UCR modernization, integration, and interoperability.

**Examples include, but are not limited to:**

- Capability gaps, overlaps, or redundancies within the UCR
- Risks, constraints, or assumptions associated with existing requirements
- Dependencies or interactions across functional areas

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- Integration or interoperability challenges
- Recommendations to improve requirement clarity, measurability, flexibility, or implementability

**TAB 4 Columns Inputs:**

- **Category Type:** Select: Gap / Risk / Observation
- **Description of Gap, Risk, or Observation:** Provide concise, non-proprietary description.
- **Currently within the UCR:** Select: Yes/No. If Yes, identify impacted area.
- **UCR Functional Area Impacted:** Select applicable functional area, if any.
- **Recommendations or Mitigation:** Provide recommended actions or considerations.

Responses should address overarching UCR considerations such as capability gaps, risks, dependencies, integration or interoperability challenges, and opportunities to improve requirement clarity, flexibility, or implementability.

All inputs must remain non-proprietary and capability focused.

**3.3 TAB 5: MODERNIZATION CONSIDERATIONS (REQUIRED)**

This tab allows respondents to propose a **future Unified Capabilities (UCR) capability structure** based on current and emerging technologies. Respondents should complete **one row per proposed capability area or capability group**.

Provide **high-level, non-proprietary** information only. Responses will be used to inform Government analysis, planning, and potential UCR updates.

**Column-Specific Guidance:**

- **Proposed Capability Area / Capability Group**  
Enter the name of the proposed future capability area or logical grouping of capabilities. This may represent:
  - A new capability not currently defined in the UCR
  - A restructured or consolidated capability grouping
  - An evolution of existing UCR capability areas
- **Description of Proposed Capability:** Provide a concise description of the proposed capability, including its intended purpose and operational value. Descriptions should focus on **what the capability enables**, not detailed technical implementation.

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- **Related Current UCR Functional Area(s):** Identify any existing UCR functional areas that relate to or would be replaced, merged, or impacted by the proposed capability. If no current UCR functional area applies, indicate “None.”
  - **Existing Enterprise Service(s):** Identify any current DoD or widely adopted enterprise services (government or commercial) that could support this capability. If no enterprise service currently exists, indicate “None Identified.”
  - **Capability Coverage Status:** Indicate the extent to which the identified enterprise service(s) currently provide the proposed capability:
    - Fully Provided
    - Partially Provided
    - Not Provided
    - Planned / In Development
    - Unknown
  - **Bundling or Consolidation Opportunity:** Indicate **Yes or No** whether this capability area presents an opportunity for bundling or consolidation with other capabilities based on technology convergence, shared infrastructure, or operational efficiencies.
  - **Rationale for Bundling or New Capability Structure:** If bundling, consolidation, or a new capability structure is proposed, provide a brief rationale. Include relevant considerations such as:
    - Integration or interoperability benefits
    - Reduction of redundancy
    - Improved user experience or mission effectiveness
    - Alignment with current or emerging technologies
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#### **4 RESPONSE GUIDELINES**

All responses must be submitted using the Government-provided Excel response template (**Attachment: UCR RFI RESPONDENT TEMPLATE**). Responses submitted in alternate formats, modified templates, or external documents may not be reviewed or considered as part of the Government’s analysis.

Respondents are requested to structure their submissions strictly in accordance with the tab organization, column headers, and instructions provided in the template to promote consistency, traceability, and efficient Government review. Responses should be clear, concise, and focused on requirements- and capability-based insights.

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Proprietary, classified, competition-sensitive, or vendor-specific information shall not be included.

### **4.1 TAB 1: INSTRUCTIONS (READ FIRST)**

This tab contains Government-provided instructions for completing the Excel response template. Instructions (shown in purple at the top of each tab) describe the purpose of the tab, required and optional fields, and formatting guidance.

Respondents shall review TAB 1 in its entirety before completing any other tabs. Respondents shall not enter data into or modify this tab or any Government-provided instructional content.

### **4.2 TAB 2: RESPONDENT INFORMATION**

Respondents shall provide general information about the responding organization, including:

- **Organization Name:** Name of the company or entity submitting the response.
- **Point of Contact:** Name, title, and email address of the primary point of contact.
- **Company Unique Entity Identifier (UEI):** Enter the organization's UEI. This is provided for Government identification purposes only.
- **Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) Code:** Enter the organization's CAGE Code. This is provided for Government identification purposes only.
- **Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplement (DFARS) Company Size Classification:** Enter the applicable classification in accordance with DFARS criteria (e.g., small business, large business, etc.).
- **Date Submitted:** Date the response is completed and submitted.

### **4.3 TAB 3: FUNCTIONAL AREA RANKING, ANALYSIS, AND RECOMMENDATIONS (REQUIRED)**

TAB 3 serves as the authoritative and primary mechanism for collecting functional area prioritization, analysis, and recommendations. Respondents shall populate all required columns and comply with conditional logic exactly as implemented in the Excel template.

#### **Mandatory Completion:**

- All rows corresponding to listed UCR functional areas shall be completed.
- Selection-based columns (e.g., relevance, priority, technology alignment) shall use only Government-provided dropdown values.
- Respondents shall not alter column headers, add rows, insert comments, or modify validation rules.

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### **Narrative Input Constraints:**

- Narrative entries are permitted only in the following columns when triggered by a corresponding Yes/No selection:
  - *Integration or Interoperability Considerations*
  - *Services/Capabilities Provided to DoD Organization(s)*
- Narrative responses shall be concise, requirements-focused, and limited to the scope of the identified functional area.

Entries in TAB 3 shall address requirements-level considerations such as operational relevance, interoperability, architectural alignment, and modernization needs. Vendor-specific solutions, proprietary approaches, pricing, schedules, or product references shall not be included.

### **4.4 TAB 4: GAPS, RISKS, AND OBSERVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

TAB 4 provides an optional mechanism for capturing cross-functional insights that are not fully represented at the individual functional area level in TAB 3.

#### **Completion Guidance:**

- Each row shall address a single gap, risk, or observation.
- The Category Type column shall be completed using only the predefined options.
- Where an issue is already reflected in the UCR, respondents shall indicate applicability and identify the impacted functional area using the designated columns.

#### **Acceptable Input Scope:**

- Capability gaps, overlaps, or redundancies
- Risks or constraints associated with existing UCR requirements
- Cross-functional dependencies or integration challenges
- Interoperability considerations spanning multiple functional areas
- Recommendations to improve requirement clarity, measurability, flexibility, or implementability

TAB 4 inputs shall remain high-level, non-proprietary, and capability-focused. Vendor-specific implementations, proprietary methodologies, or product references shall not be included.

### **4.5 TAB 5: MODERNIZATION CONSIDERATIONS (REQUIRED)**

Tab 5 allows respondents to propose future-state UCR structure and identify modernization opportunities based on current and emerging technologies.



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Respondents should use this tab to:

- Propose **new or revised capability areas** that are not fully represented in the current UCR.
- Identify **current enterprise services** (DoD or commercial) that could support future UCR capability needs.
- Indicate when **no enterprise service currently exists** for a specific capability area.
- Identify **capability areas where bundling or consolidation** may be appropriate based on technological convergence, shared infrastructure, or operational efficiencies.

For each proposed future capability, respondents should provide high-level, **non-proprietary** input addressing:

- Capability description and intended operational value
- Relationship to existing UCR functional areas (if applicable)
- Potential integration or interoperability considerations
- Dependencies, assumptions, or enabling technologies

Responses should be **concise, strategic, and forward-looking**, and focused on informing Government analysis, planning, and potential UCR updates. Detailed technical designs or proprietary information are **not required**.

The response should not exceed a five (5) MB e-mail limit for all items associated with the RFI response. Oral communications are not permissible. SAM.gov will be the sole repository for all information related to this RFI. Companies who wish to respond to this RFI should send responses via e-mail no later than **12:00 p.m. Eastern on February 25, 2025**, to **disa.meade.mbx.ucr@mail.mil**. All responses should reference “**UCR RFI Response**” in the e-mail subject line.

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### 5 INDUSTRY DISCUSSIONS

At the Government’s discretion, DISA representatives **may** conduct follow-on discussions with respondents for the limited purpose of seeking clarification or additional information related to submitted responses. Any such discussions will be conducted solely to support market research and to enhance the Government’s understanding of general considerations. Participation in any discussions is voluntary and do not constitute a commitment by the Government to pursue an acquisition, solicitation, or engage in contractual activity.

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**6 QUESTIONS**

Questions regarding this announcement shall be submitted in writing by e-mail to **disa.meade.mbx.ucr@mail.mil**. Any questions submitted shall reference **“UCR Questions”** in the subject line of the e-mail.

Verbal questions will NOT be accepted. All questions must be sent via the email above and the responses will be posted to SAM.gov. The Government does not guarantee that questions received after **12:00 p.m.** Eastern on February 26, 2025, will be answered. The Government will not reimburse companies for any costs associated with the submission of their responses.

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**DISCLAIMER**

**This RFI is not an RFP and is not to be construed as a commitment by the Government to issue a solicitation or ultimately award a contract.** Responses will not be considered as proposals, nor will any award be made as a result of this synopsis.

All information contained in the RFI is preliminary, subject to modification, and is in no way binding to the Government. FAR clause 52.215-3, “Request for Information or Solicitation for Planning Purposes”, is incorporated for reference with this RFI. The Government does not intend to pay for information received in response to this RFI and responders to this invitation are solely responsible for all expenses associated with responding to this RFI. This RFI will be the basis for collecting information on capabilities available and is issued solely for information and planning purposes. Proprietary information and trade secrets, if any, must be clearly marked on all materials. All information received in this RFI that is marked “Proprietary” will be handled accordingly. Please be advised that all submissions become Government property and will not be returned nor will receipt be confirmed. In accordance with FAR 15.201(e), responses to this RFI are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding contract. No contractual action is anticipated at this time.